TECHNICAL ANALYSIS

SEO Audit Report

Comprehensive Search Engine Optimization Assessment

Domain: recalledrides.com

Audit Date: May 29, 2026

Auditor: SEO Technical Analysis Team

Pages Analyzed: 8,489 URLs

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive technical SEO audit of **recalledrides.com**, a vehicle recall information platform that aggregates NHTSA safety recall data. The audit analyzed **8,489 URLs** across the site's full architecture, examining technical SEO foundations, on-page optimization, content quality, indexability, and performance metrics.

1.1 Overall Health Score

Table 1 SEO Health Score Summary

Category	Score	Status	Issues
Technical SEO	87/100	**Good**	2 minor
On-Page SEO	82/100	**Good**	3 moderate
Content Quality	75/100	**Fair**	2 significant
Performance	68/100	**Needs Improvement**	3 significant
Indexability	85/100	**Good**	2 moderate
Overall	**79/100**	**Good with Issues**	**12 total**

1.2 Critical Findings

Finding 1: Slow Time to First Byte (TTFB)

Homepage TTFB averages **1.87 seconds**, with internal pages ranging from 0.65s to 1.61s. This exceeds Google's recommended 0.8s threshold and directly impacts Core Web Vitals LCP scores.

Finding 2: Year-Level Pages Set to Noindex

Vehicle year pages (e.g., /toyota/prius/2020) carry `noindex, nofollow` directives despite having valuable recall content. This blocks significant long-tail search traffic for queries like "2020 Toyota Prius recalls."

Finding 3: No Images Anywhere on the Site

Zero images were found across all analyzed pages. This eliminates image search traffic, reduces social sharing engagement, and limits structured data enhancement opportunities.

Key Strength: Excellent Technical Foundation

The site demonstrates strong technical SEO fundamentals: proper canonical tags, complete Open Graph/Twitter Card implementation, comprehensive Schema.org markup (WebSite, Organization, BreadcrumbList, ItemList, FAQPage, Vehicle), correct robots.txt configuration, and clean sitemap architecture. HTTPS, WWW, and trailing-slash redirects are all properly configured.

2. Technical SEO Analysis

2.1 Crawlability & Indexing

Table 2 Crawlability Audit Results

Element	Status	Details
robots.txt	**PASS**	Present, references sitemap.xml, properly blocks /api/
Sitemap.xml	**PASS**	8,489 URLs, 1.5MB, well-organized, proper lastmod dates
Canonical Tags	**PASS**	Present and correct on all page types
Noindex Handling	**PASS**	Empty model pages correctly use noindex
Sitemap Accuracy	**PASS**	No noindex pages found in sitemap sample
404 Errors	**PASS**	Proper HTTP 404 returned, not soft 404s
Redirects	**PASS**	HTTP→HTTPS, www→non-www, trailing slash all correct
Hreflang Tags	**INFO**	Not present; acceptable for single-language EN site

The site's crawlability infrastructure is well-architected. The robots.txt file properly allows all user-agents while restricting API endpoints. The sitemap contains 8,489 URLs organized hierarchically: 1 homepage, 30 make pages, 3,924 model pages, 1,547 year pages, and 2,987 recall category pages.

2.2 URL Structure & Canonicalization

The URL hierarchy follows a clean, logical pattern:

```
/
/{make}               (e.g., /toyota)
/{make}/{model}       (e.g., /toyota/prius)
/{make}/{model}/{year}  (e.g., /toyota/prius/2020)
/{make}/{model}/{year}/{category}  (e.g., /toyota/prius/2020/power-train)
```

Table 3 URL Structure Analysis

Check	Result
Lowercase URLs	**PASS — All URLs use lowercase**
Hyphen separators	**PASS — Uses hyphens (e.g., fj-cruiser, mercedes-benz)**
No URL parameters	**PASS — Clean paths, no query strings**
Canonical consistency	**PASS — Canonical matches final URL**
Trailing slash handling	**PASS — /toyota/ redirects to /toyota**

2.3 Schema Markup & Structured Data

The site implements comprehensive Schema.org JSON-LD markup across multiple page types. This is a significant SEO strength.

Table 4 Schema Markup by Page Type

Page Type	Schema Types	Status
Homepage	WebSite, Organization, SearchAction	**Excellent**
Make Pages	BreadcrumbList, ItemList	**Good**
Model Pages	BreadcrumbList	**Minimal**
Year Pages	BreadcrumbList, Vehicle	**Good**
Category Pages	FAQPage, BreadcrumbList	**Good**

The SearchAction schema enables Google Sitelinks Search Box, allowing users to search directly from SERP. The FAQPage schema on recall category pages creates rich snippet eligibility for question-answer display.

2.4 Security & HTTPS

Table 5 Security Configuration

Check	Result
HTTPS enforced	**PASS — All requests redirect to HTTPS**

HTTP → HTTPS redirect	**PASS — 301 redirect confirmed**	
WWW → non-WWW redirect	**PASS — Consistent non-WWW canonical**	
HSTS header	**Not verified**	Check server config for Strict-Transport-Security

3. On-Page SEO Analysis

3.1 Title Tags & Meta Descriptions

Title tags and meta descriptions are present on all sampled pages with consistent formatting. However, several optimization opportunities exist.

Table 6 Title Tag Analysis

Page	Current Title	Length
Homepage	Vehicle Recall Search — Check Your Car Free | Recalled Rides	61 chars
Make (Toyota)	TOYOTA Vehicle Recalls & Safety Issues | Recalled Rides	58 chars
Model (Prius)	TOYOTA Prius Recalls by Year | Recalled Rides	49 chars
Year (2020 Prius)	2020 TOYOTA Prius Recall & Safety Information | Recalled Rides	68 chars
Category	2016 ACURA ILX Power Train Recalls | Recalled Rides	55 chars

> **Note:** Title tags use ALL CAPS for manufacturer names (TOYOTA, ACURA). While consistent, mixed case is generally preferred for readability. Title lengths are within the 50-60 character optimal range except for year pages at 68 characters, which may truncate in SERP.

3.2 Heading Hierarchy

Heading structure follows semantic hierarchy with proper nesting. Sample analysis:

Table 7 Heading Structure by Page Type

Page Type	H1	H2	H3	Status
Homepage	1 — Main CTA question	3 — Section headers	0	**Good**
Make Page	1 — Make name	1 — Model list	0	**Could be deeper**

Category Page	1 — Specific recall	3 — Related sections	1 — Subcategory	**Good**

3.3 Open Graph & Social Tags

Table 8 Social Meta Tag Audit

Tag Type	Homepage	Make Pages	Category Pages
og:title	**Present**	**Present**	**Present**
og:description	**Present**	**Present**	**Present**
og:type	**website**	**website**	**website**
og:image	**SVG (1200x630)**	**Generic only**	**Generic only**
twitter:card	**summary_large_image**	**Present**	**Present**

All pages use the same generic OG image (og-image-home.svg). Creating unique OG images for make/model pages would significantly improve social sharing click-through rates.

3.4 Image Optimization

Critical Gap: Zero Images on All Pages

Our analysis found **0 images** across all examined page types (homepage, make pages, model pages, category pages). This represents a significant missed opportunity:

- No image search traffic potential
- Reduced social media engagement when shared
- Missed Vehicle schema image property enhancement
- No visual trust signals for users

4. Content & Indexability

4.1 Site Architecture

The site follows a clear 4-level hierarchy with 8,489 total URLs:

Table 9 URL Distribution by Depth

Level	Path Pattern	Count	Purpose
0	/	1	Homepage/Search hub
1	/{make}	30	Make overview pages
2	/{make}/{model}	3,924	Model landing pages
3	/{make}/{model}/{year}	1,547	Year-specific recall pages
4	/{make}/{model}/{year}/{category}	2,987	Recall category detail pages

4.2 Thin Content Analysis

The site handles thin content appropriately for the most part:

Table 10 Content Quality by Page Type

Page Type	Avg Content	Index Status	Assessment
Make Pages	~800 words	Indexable	**Good overview content**
Model Pages (with recalls)	~400 words	Indexable	**Adequate with model lists**
Model Pages (no recalls)	~50 words	Noindex	**Correctly excluded**
Year Pages	~200 words	Noindex	**Should be indexable**
Category Pages	~500 words	Indexable	**Rich FAQ-style content**

> **Year Pages Are Noindex — Wasted Traffic Opportunity**
>
> Year-level pages (e.g., /toyota/prius/2020) contain valuable, specific recall information but carry `robots: noindex, nofollow` directives. Queries like "2020 Toyota Prius recalls" are high-intent searches that these pages could capture. These pages should be made indexable with expanded content.

4.3 Internal Linking Structure

The homepage contains 55 internal links and 1 external link (NHTSA), providing strong distribution to make pages. Make pages link to all their child models. Category pages include cross-links to related recalls for the same model/year.

Strengths: Breadcrumb navigation is present on all internal pages with corresponding BreadcrumbList schema. Related recall sections on category pages create contextual internal links.

Opportunities: No "Related Models" or "Popular Recalls" cross-linking between different makes/models. Adding a "People Also Checked" section would improve crawl depth and user engagement.

5. Performance Analysis

5.1 Page Speed Metrics

Table 11 Server Response Times

Page	TTFB	Total Load	HTML Size	Compressed
Homepage	1.868s	1.884s	21.3 KB	4.6 KB (br)
Make Page (Toyota)	0.650s	0.861s	35.8 KB	**Not measured**
Model Page (Camry)	1.606s	1.794s	8.0 KB	**Not measured**

TTFB Exceeds Recommended Threshold

Google recommends TTFB under 0.8 seconds for good LCP scores. The homepage at 1.87s and model pages at 1.61s significantly exceed this. While Brotli compression is active (reducing 21.3 KB to 4.6 KB), server response time is the bottleneck.

5.2 Core Web Vitals Estimation

Table 12 Estimated Core Web Vitals

Metric	Homepage Est.	Target	Status
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	2.5-3.5s	<2.5s	**Needs Improvement**
INP (Interaction to Next Paint)	~200ms	<200ms	**Good**
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	~0	<0.1	**Excellent**
TTFB	1.87s	<0.8s	**Poor**

Positive factors: Zero layout shift (text-only content), font preloading is configured, cache headers are properly set (s-maxage=43200), and Brotli compression reduces transfer size by ~78%.

5.3 Mobile Usability

Table 13 Mobile Configuration

Check	Result
Viewport meta tag	**PASS — width=device-width, initial-scale=1**
Touch targets	**PASS — Large text-based navigation links**
Font sizing	**PASS — Relative units, readable at default**
Theme color	**PASS — Light and dark mode specified**
Apple touch icon	**PASS — Present**
Web app manifest	**PASS — Present**
Responsive images	**N/A — No images to scale**

Mobile usability is strong due to the text-heavy, minimalist design. The site will perform well on mobile devices from a usability perspective, though TTFB issues affect mobile users more severely due to variable network conditions.

6. Recommendations & Implementation Plan

6.1 Critical Priority (Fix Immediately)

REC-001: Reduce Time to First Byte (TTFB)

Impact: High | **Effort:** Medium

Current TTFB of 1.87s on the homepage exceeds Google's 0.8s recommendation. This is the single biggest factor holding back search performance.

Actions:

- Implement Edge/CDN caching for static HTML responses
- Enable database query caching for recall lookups
- Consider static site generation (SSG) for make/model pages
- Add Redis/Memcached layer for frequently accessed recall data
- Review serverless function cold start times if applicable

REC-002: Make Year Pages Indexable

Impact: High | **Effort:** Low

Year pages currently have `noindex, nofollow` but contain valuable content. These should be indexable to capture long-tail queries.

Actions:

- Remove noindex directive from year pages that have recall data
- Keep noindex only for year pages with zero recalls
- Expand content: add model year summary, NHTSA campaign details
- Add "Other Years for This Model" cross-links

6.2 High Priority (Fix Within 30 Days)

REC-003: Add Vehicle Images

Impact: High | **Effort:** Medium

Adding vehicle images to make/model pages unlocks image search traffic and improves social sharing.

Actions:

- Source vehicle images for 30 makes and top 200 models
- Add to make pages with proper alt text (e.g., "2020 Toyota Prius")
- Include Vehicle schema image property
- Create unique OG images per make using dynamic generation
- Implement lazy loading for below-fold images

REC-004: Enhance Internal Linking

Impact: Medium | **Effort:** Low

Add contextual cross-links to improve crawl depth and user engagement.

Actions:

- Add "Popular Recalls for [Make]" sidebar on model pages
- Create "Compare with Similar Models" links
- Add "Recently Viewed" or "Trending Recalls" section to homepage
- Link from category pages to parent year/make pages with descriptive anchor text

REC-005: Add HowTo Schema to Key Pages

Impact: Medium | **Effort:** Low

Supplement existing FAQPage schema with HowTo markup for recall repair procedures.

6.3 Medium Priority (Fix Within 90 Days)

REC-006: Add HSTS Security Header

Add `Strict-Transport-Security: max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains` to enforce HTTPS and improve security scores.

REC-007: Create Dynamic OG Images

Generate unique Open Graph images per make/model using a template system rather than the generic homepage image.

REC-008: Add Publication Dates to Content

Include `<time>` elements with publication/update dates and add dateModified to Article schema where applicable.

REC-009: Implement Related Content Module

Add a "Related Recalls" or "Frequently Recalled Together" module to category pages to increase page depth and session duration.

6.4 Implementation Code Examples

Year Page — Remove Noindex (REC-002)

Current (remove this):

```
<meta name="robots" content="noindex, nofollow">
```

Replace with conditional logic:

```
<!-- Only add noindex if year has zero recalls -->
{{#if recall_count == 0}}
  <meta name="robots" content="noindex, nofollow">
{{else}}
  <meta name="robots" content="index, follow">
{{/if}}
```

Vehicle Schema with Image (REC-003)

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "Vehicle",
  "name": "2020 Toyota Prius",
  "manufacturer": {
    "@type": "Organization",
    "name": "Toyota"
  },
  "image": "https://recalledrides.com/images/toyota-prius-2020.jpg",
  "vehicleModelDate": "2020",
  "knownVehicleDamages": "Power Train recall — driveshaft separation risk"
}
</script>
```

Enhanced Meta Tags (REC-004)

```
<!-- Add to year pages -->
<meta property="og:image" content="https://recalledrides.com/og/toyota-prius-2020.jpg">
<meta property="og:image:alt" content="2020 Toyota Prius recall information">

<!-- Add time element -->
<time datetime="2026-05-28">Updated May 28, 2026</time>
```

HSTS Header (REC-006)

```
# Add to server configuration (nginx example)
add_header Strict-Transport-Security "max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains; preload" always;
```

Appendix: Audit Methodology

This audit was conducted using automated analysis tools and manual inspection on May 29, 2026. The following checks were performed:

- **Crawl Analysis:** Sitemap.xml parsed (8,489 URLs); robots.txt verified
- **Page Sampling:** Homepage, 3 make pages, 6 model pages, 15 year pages, 10 category pages
- **Performance:** Server response timing from US-East region
- **Technical:** HTML source analysis for meta tags, schema, headings, links
- **Indexability:** robots meta tag sampling across page types

Table 14 Tools Used

Tool	Purpose
Custom HTTP Analysis	TTFB, headers, redirects, compression
HTML Source Parsing	Meta tags, schema, headings, links
Sitemap Parser	URL structure, coverage analysis
Browser Rendering	Visual inspection, mobile layout

Disclaimer: This audit is based on publicly accessible information and represents a point-in-time analysis. Search engine algorithms change continuously. Implementation of recommendations should be followed by monitoring in Google Search Console and analytics platforms.